

# Tenant Rights Quick Reference

*Virginia Residential Landlord-Tenant Act Guide*

## **I. Eviction Process and Timelines**

Landlords cannot lock you out or cut utilities. They must issue a written notice (e.g. 5-Day Pay or Quit), file an Unlawful Detainer, and win in court.

## **II. Habitability Standards & Repairs**

Landlords must maintain clean running water, heat, and structural integrity. If they fail, file a Tenant's Assertion in court.

## **III. Security Deposit Guidelines**

Landlords must return deposits within 45 days of lease termination, with an itemized list of any deductions.

## **IV. Eviction & Organizing Legality**

Tenants have the absolute legal right to organize a tenants association. Landlord retaliation is strictly prohibited by law.

**Radiant Threshold · Injustice Reform Network**

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